Section I

READING

a. Underline the words or phrases that tell you what the wind does to the village.

b. Write the names of the characters in this story.

1. _____ **2.** _____ **3.** _____

Who - Whoo, Whooo, cried the wind as it swept down from the Himalayan snows. It hurried over the hills and passes, and hummed and **moaned** in the tall pines and deodars.

On **Haunted** Hill there was little to stop the wind–only a few stunted trees and bushes, and the **ruins** of what had once been a small settlement.

On the slopes of the next hill there was a small village. People kept large stones on their tin roofs to prevent them from blowing away. There was nearly always a wind in these parts. Even on sunny days, doors and windows rattled, chimneys choked, clothes blew away.

Three children stood beside a low stone wall, spreading clothes out to dry. On each garment they placed a rock. Even then the clothes fluttered like flags and pennants.



Usha, dark haired and rose cheeked, struggled with her grandfather's long loose shirt. She was eleven or twelve. Her younger brother, Suresh, was doing his best to hold down a bed-sheet while Binya, a slightly older girl, Usha's friend and neighbour, was handing them the clothes, one at a time.

Once they were sure everything was on the wall, firmly held down by rocks, they

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